

[Menu](#)

Batch Operations

▼ Relevant source files

`hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js``hclient/framecontent/recordAction.php``hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js``hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuCollected.html``hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuRecode.html``hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuSelected.html``hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuShared.html`

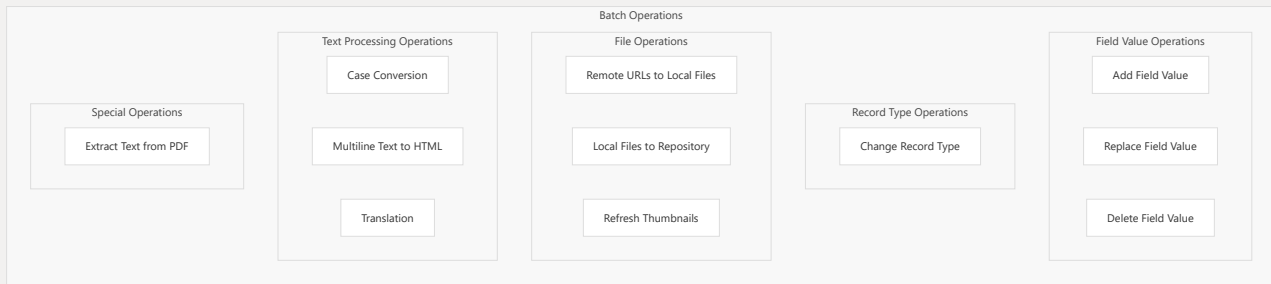
Batch Operations in Heurist allow users to perform actions on multiple records simultaneously, providing an efficient way to maintain data consistency and make bulk updates. This page documents the batch operations framework, including available operations, record selection methods, configuration options, and technical implementation.

Purpose and Scope

This document covers the batch operations system in Heurist, which enables users to modify multiple records at once. It details how to access and use batch operations, the types of operations available, and the underlying technical implementation. For information about individual record editing, see [Record Editing](#), and for file handling operations, see [File Management](#).

Overview of Batch Operations

Heurist provides a comprehensive set of batch operations accessible through the result list menu interface. These operations are grouped into several categories:

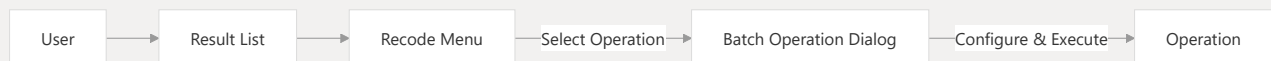


Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuRecode.html`

`hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 32-42

Accessing Batch Operations

Batch operations are primarily accessed through the "Recode" menu in the result list interface, though some operations are also available through the "Selected" and "Shared" menus.



Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 20-63

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuRecode.html`

Menu Structure

The batch operations are organized into several menus:

1. **Recode Menu:** Contains most field and file operations
 - Add/Replace/Delete Field Value
 - Change Record Type
 - URL to File conversions
 - Text processing operations
2. **Selected Menu:** Contains operations for selected records
 - Select all/none
 - Show selected
 - Tag/Rate/Bookmark
 - Merge/Delete
3. **Shared Menu:** Contains sharing-related operations

- Email notifications
- Ownership/visibility settings

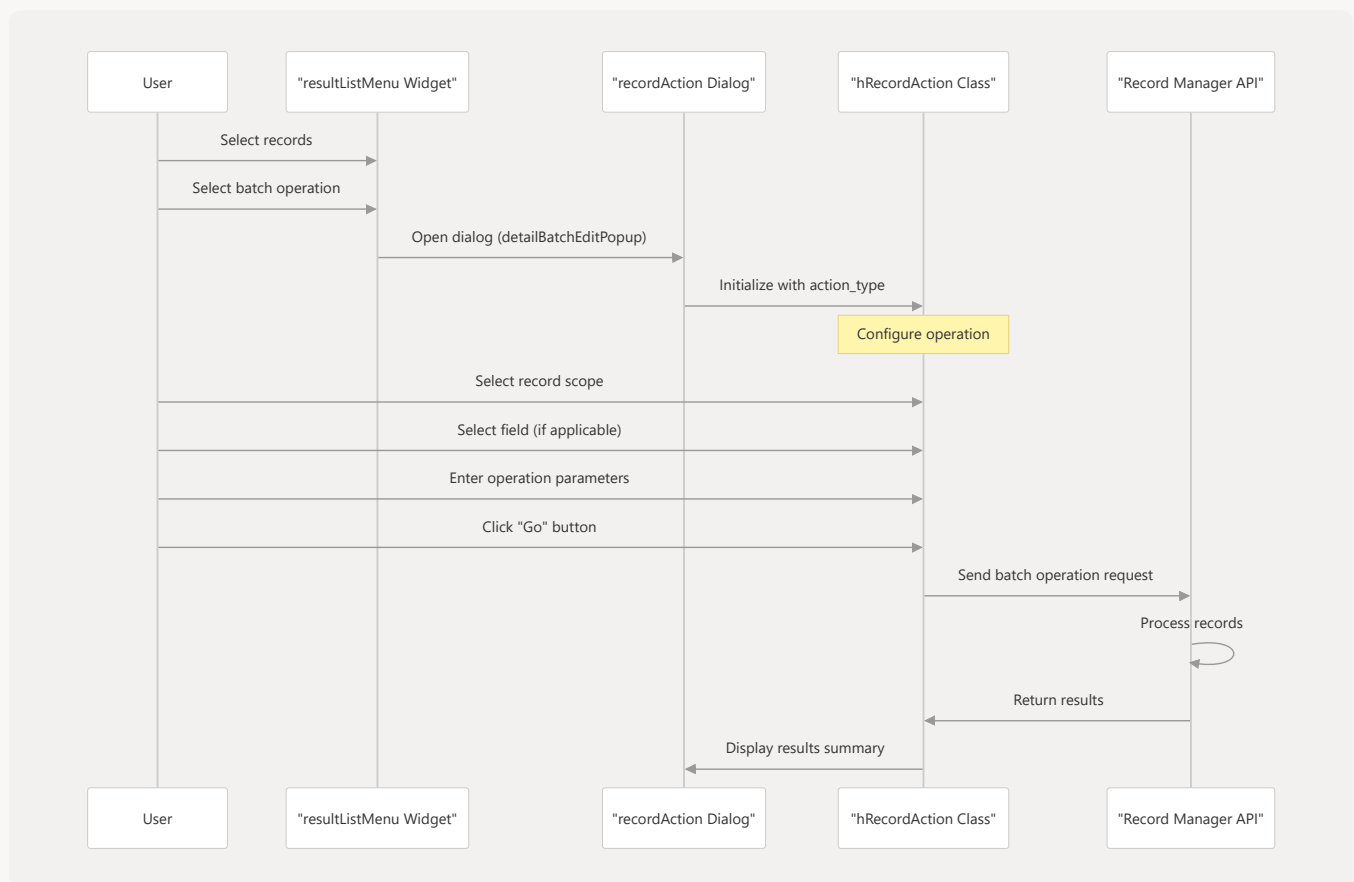
Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuRecode.html`

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuSelected.html`

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuShared.html`

Operation Workflow

The batch operation process follows a consistent workflow:



Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 763-801

`hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 732-902

Record Selection Scopes

Batch operations can be applied to different scopes of records:

1. **All Records:** All records in the database (available for certain operations)
2. **Current Results:** All records in the current search result set
3. **Selected Records:** Only records manually selected by the user

4. **Collected Records:** Records that have been collected by the user

5. **Records by Type:** Only records of a specific record type

The scope selection is handled by the `_fillSelectRecordScope()` function in the `hRecordAction` class.

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 140-203

Field Value Operations

Add Field Value

Adds a specified value to a field in all selected records. This operation appends the value to any existing values in the field.

Replace Field Value

Replaces values in a field across selected records with several options:

1. **Replace all values:** Replaces all existing values with the new value
2. **Replace complete value:** Replaces only values that exactly match the search value
3. **Replace substring:** Replaces only portions of values that match the search value

Delete Field Value

Removes values from a field in selected records with three options:

1. **Remove all values:** Clears all values from the field
2. **Remove search string only:** Removes only portions of values that match the search string
3. **Remove complete value:** Removes only values that exactly match the search string

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 327-408

File Operations

Remote URLs to Local Files

Downloads files from URLs stored in file fields and saves them to the local Heurist file storage. Options include:

- URL filtering (only URLs containing a specific substring)
- File name matching (use existing files with matching names)

Local Files to Repository

Uploads files from Heurist's local storage to an external repository (e.g., Nakala). Options include:

- Repository selection
- License selection (for Nakala)
- Option to delete local files after successful upload

Refresh Thumbnails

Regenerates thumbnails for image files in the selected records, with an option to tag affected records.

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 410-482

Text Processing Operations

Case Conversion

Modifies the case of text in specified fields with several options:

1. **Sentence case:** Lowercase with capital at start and after periods
2. **Title case:** Capitalize the first letter of each word
3. **Lowercase:** Convert all text to lowercase
4. **Uppercase:** Convert all text to uppercase

Users can also specify exceptions that should not be modified by case conversion.

Multiline Text to HTML

Converts newlines in text fields to HTML `<br>` tags, making the text display properly in HTML contexts.

Translation

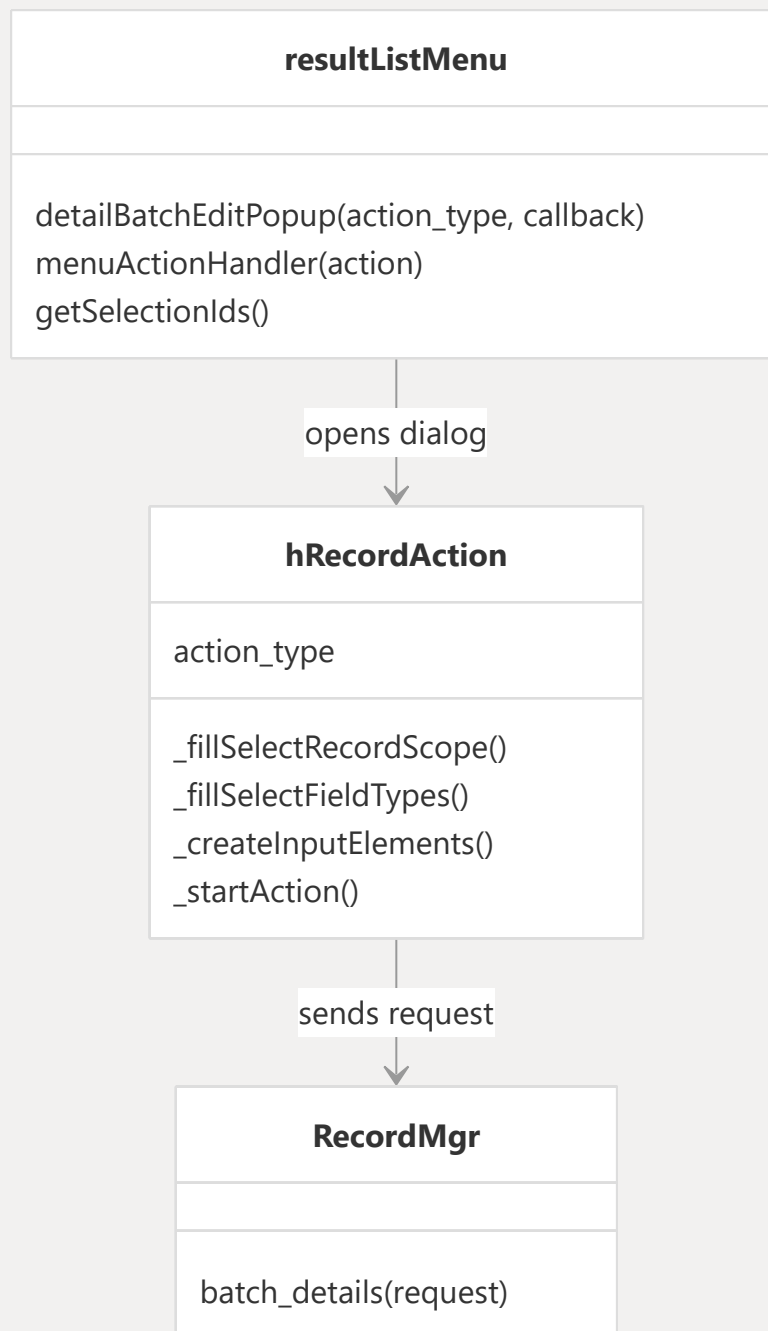
Translates text from one language to another using an external translation API. Options include:

- Target language selection
- Handling of existing translations (keep, replace, or delete)

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 483-581

Technical Implementation

Key Components



Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 42-902

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 20-805

Dialog Structure

The batch operation dialog is structured as follows:

1. **Header:** Describes the operation
2. **Record Scope Selection:** Dropdown for selecting which records to affect
3. **Field Type Selection:** For operations that modify field values

4. **Operation-specific Inputs:** Custom inputs for the specific operation
5. **Action Buttons:** "Go" and "Cancel" buttons
6. **Results Section:** Displays operation results after execution

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.php` 134-190

Record Scope Selection

The record scope is managed by the `_fillSelectRecordScope()` function, which:

1. Gets available scopes based on current context and operation type
2. Populates the dropdown with appropriate options
3. Handles the selection change event

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 140-203

Field Type Selection

For operations that modify field values, the field selection is managed by the `_fillSelectFieldTypes()` function, which:

1. Gets available fields based on selected record scope
2. Filters fields based on operation type
3. Populates the dropdown with appropriate options

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 264-322

Operation Execution

The batch operation is executed by the `_startAction()` function, which:

1. Collects operation parameters from the UI
2. Validates the parameters
3. Sends the request to the server
4. Displays the results to the user

Sources: `hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 732-902

Permission Requirements

Most batch operations require user authentication. Additionally, certain operations require specific permission levels:

Operation	Required Permission
Basic field operations	Logged-in user
Change record types	Logged-in user
File operations	Logged-in user
Delete records	Delete permission for records
Change ownership/visibility	Database manager
Merging records	Database manager

Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 144-184

Integration with Other Systems

The batch operations system integrates with several other Heurist subsystems:

- 1. **Search System:** For selecting records to operate on
- 2. **Record Management:** For modifying record data
- 3. **File Management:** For file operations
- 4. **UI Framework:** For providing the user interface

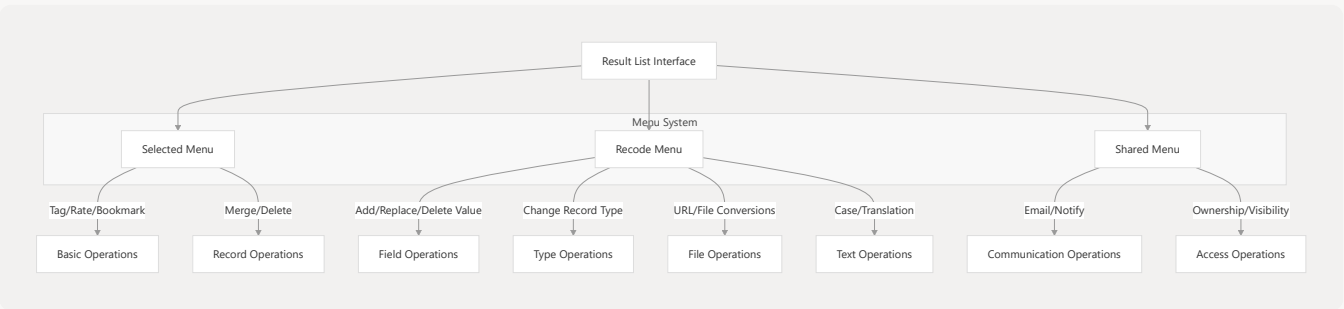
When batch operations complete, they trigger appropriate events to update the UI and refresh affected components.

Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 72-107

`hclient/framecontent/recordAction.js` 885-902

Batch Operation Menu Access Points

The batch operations can be accessed from different menus in the result list interface:



Sources: `hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenu.js` 44-55

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuRecode.html`

`hclient/widgets/viewers/resultListMenuSelected.html`